A MAJHI GROUP DEFINITIVE GUIDE

The Executive Search Playbook

How to close the right VP or C-suite hire in 50 days — and why most searches take 120

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40%	14 wk	50 days	25+
EXECUTIVE HIRES FAIL WITHIN 18 MONTHS	INDUSTRY MEDIAN FOR VP-LEVEL CLOSE	MAJHI GROUP AVERAGE CLOSE ON RETAINED SEARCH	C-SUITE & VP PLACEMENTS COMPLETED

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This guide is written for CEOs and Founders who are about to hire — or are currently stuck on — a VP or C-suite search. It is not a pitch document. It is an honest account of how executive searches fail, what the data actually shows, and what a different execution system produces. Read it cover to cover before your next search starts.

INTRODUCTION · SECTION 00

00

Why the Search Keeps Failing

40% of executive hires fail within 18 months of joining. This number has not moved in two decades — not because the talent market has gotten harder, and not because companies are hiring less carefully. It has not moved because the process is optimized for the wrong thing.

The standard VP or C-suite search process is optimized to produce a hire. Not to produce a successful leader. Those two objectives overlap significantly, but they diverge in exactly the places where failures are born: in the precision of the role definition, in the quality of the evaluation, in the alignment between the fee structure and the outcome, and in the support the new hire receives in their first 90 days.

When a search fails — when a VP leaves in 14 months, when a hiring manager passes on three shortlists in a row, when a search that was supposed to take six weeks takes 20 — the explanation is almost always some version of "the market was tight" or "the candidate pool was smaller than expected." These explanations are wrong. They feel true because they reference real factors. But they almost never describe the actual cause.

40%	68%	14 wk
EXECUTIVE HIRES FAIL WITHIN 18 MONTHS	VP SEARCHES STALL PAST WEEK 10	INDUSTRY MEDIAN FOR VP-LEVEL CLOSE

These numbers are not the result of a thin talent market. They are the result of a process that has not been updated to match the actual complexity of executive hiring in a modern organization.

This guide is organized around the specific places where searches fail, and what a different process produces in each of them. The chapters move from the beginning of a search — how you define the role — through to the end — how you ensure the person you hired actually succeeds. Each chapter draws on real search data, case studies, and the operational patterns that appear consistently across VP and C-suite mandates.

THE CORE ARGUMENT

The gap between a 14-week search and a 50-day close is not the talent market. It is execution infrastructure — specifically, whether the search is designed to produce quality outcomes or merely to produce hires. These are different designs, with different processes, different incentives, and consistently different results.

The proof point is simple: a $275K VP-level search that two firms couldn't close in 60+ days each closed in 41 days on a retained engagement with a different process. The talent market didn't change. The candidate pool didn't expand. The process changed.

That is what this guide is about.

CHAPTER 01 · BEFORE YOU SEARCH

The Role Brief, Not the Job Description

01

The single most common cause of executive search failure has nothing to do with the talent market, the search firm, or the outreach sequence. It happens before the search starts — in how the role is defined.

Most VP and C-suite searches begin with a job description. The job description specifies qualifications: years of experience, industry background, technical credentials, and a list of responsibilities. It is inherited, largely, from the person who previously held the role, or from a template, or from a job posting a competitor ran six months ago.

Job descriptions describe the label on the box. They rarely describe what is actually needed inside it.

What a Role Brief Actually Contains

A role brief starts from a different question: what does the incoming leader actually need to accomplish in their first 12 months, and what organizational context will they be operating in when they try to do it?

This question produces a substantially different document. Instead of credentials, it specifies challenges: the specific competitive pressure the VP of Sales needs to respond to, the organizational dynamic the new CHRO will need to navigate, the technical debt the incoming VP of Engineering will inherit. Instead of experience requirements, it specifies the qualities that generate the performance the context demands — judgment, adaptability, the ability to build trust across a specific type of organization.

The practical difference: a role brief typically produces required candidate profiles that are 30–40% different from the job description for the same role. Roles are advertised with experience requirements that are the legacy of who previously held them. The intelligence approach derives requirements from the current context, not from the previous holder of the title.

> OPERATIONAL CONSEQUENCE
>
> When a search runs on a job description instead of a role brief, the evaluation framework is wrong from day one. Candidates are screened against criteria that may not match what the role actually requires. The shortlist approval rate falls. Rework cycles begin. The timeline extends — and no one understands why, because the cause is invisible in the process.

The Ghost Job Problem

Before any search begins, a mandatory check: is the seat actually open? Roles are frequently posted while a candidate is already in late-stage interviews. Someone already holds the title at TheOrg.com or LinkedIn People tab. The role is a ghost job — open on paper, filled in practice.

Every search engagement must begin with a ghost job verification across LinkedIn People, TheOrg.com, and RocketReach. This is not skepticism — it is due diligence. A search that begins on a ghost job wastes the client's time and damages their employer brand with every unnecessary approach to a candidate.

When a Search Is Ready to Start

A search is operationally ready when three conditions are met: the role brief has been completed and signed off by the relevant decision-maker; the ghost job check has returned clear; and the internal approval and compensation structure has been confirmed. Searches that begin before these conditions are met consistently produce complications in the final stages — offer rejections, unexpected negotiation complexity, and delays that could have been prevented at intake.

ROLE BRIEF CHECKLIST

— What specific challenge does this leader need to solve in months 1–6?

— What organizational dynamics will they inherit on day one?

— What does success look like at the 12-month mark — specifically?

— What has been tried before? Why did it not work?

— Who are the key stakeholders and what are their expectations?

— What is the compensation structure and has it been approved?

— Ghost job check complete — seat confirmed vacant?

CHAPTER 02 · BEFORE YOU SEARCH

The Real Cost of the Wrong Hire

The conventional figure cited for the cost of a bad senior hire is 6–9 months of salary. This figure is wrong — not in the sense of being inaccurate, but in the sense of measuring the wrong things.

Salary multipliers capture severance, recruitment costs, and the productivity gap during vacancy. They do not capture what happens to an organization while the wrong leader is in place before they leave, and they do not capture the opportunity cost of the outcomes that did not materialize because the right person was not there to produce them.

Visible vs. Invisible Harm

A wrong senior leader does two kinds of damage simultaneously. The visible harm is easier to attribute: failed product launches, missed revenue targets, team members who resign citing leadership. These get discussed in retrospectives and eventually lead to the decision to make a change.

The invisible harm is harder to see because it is defined by what does not happen. The market opportunity that is not pursued because the leader does not see it. The talent that does not join because the team's reputation deteriorates before anyone outside the organization notices. The competitive response that is not made because the leader is optimizing for their own survival. The strategic decision that gets deferred because the leader has learned to avoid accountability for outcomes.

> **INVISIBLE HARM IS ALWAYS LARGER**
>
> Organizations doing serious retrospectives on failed leadership hires consistently identify the invisible harm as larger than the visible harm. The absence of the outcomes the right person would have produced is a loss that appears on no financial statement, gets attributed to market conditions, and is systematically underestimated.

The Compounding Problem

Leadership failure in senior roles does not stay contained to the leader's function. It compounds across the organization in ways that persist long after the individual has left.

A VP of Sales who is wrong for the role deteriorates the team structure they inherit. The salespeople who can generate elsewhere leave, reducing the team to its least mobile members. The ones who remain adapt to the incentive structure the leader creates. By the time the VP is replaced, the sales organization has been reshaped by 18 months of misaligned optimization, and the new VP inherits a different problem than the role description specified.

The same dynamic plays in engineering (technical debt), people (cultural damage), and product (strategic drift). Each of these represents a cost that follows the organization for years — and none of it appears in the salary multiplier calculation.

TRUE COST COMPONENTS OF A FAILED VP HIRE

SEVERANCE + REPLACEMENT RECRUITMENT ~$80K

PRODUCTIVITY GAP DURING VACANCY (12–20 WKS) ~$180K

CHAPTER 03 · HOW SEARCHES FAIL

03

Why the Fee Structure Determines the Outcome

Retained search is frequently misunderstood as a premium price for the same process. It is not. The price difference reflects a different process entirely — one aligned to the quality of the outcome rather than the speed of the close.

The Incentive Misalignment in Contingency Search

Contingency search firms are paid only on placement. This creates a specific and well-documented incentive: the economic pressure is toward speed and volume, not quality and fit. On a contingency search, the firm's revenue depends on moving candidates toward offer as efficiently as possible.

The operational consequences of this structure are predictable. Evidence-backed dossiers slow things down. Structured evaluation frameworks add time. Honest risk assessment creates conversations that stall momentum. The incentive system is not designed to produce them, because the process is optimized for a different outcome.

Dimension Contingency Search Retained Search Fee trigger Placement only Milestone-based Primary incentive Speed to close Quality of outcome Exclusivity Non-exclusive (parallel firms) Exclusive engagement Evaluation depth Resume + impression Evidence dossier + reference Risk alignment Client bears all risk Firm stands behind outcome Replacement guarantee Rare, limited 90-day replacement standard

The 41-Day Case Study

A $275K VP-level search came to Majhi Group mid-engagement. Two firms had been working the role for more than 60 days each. Neither had produced a shortlist the CEO was willing to move forward on. The talent market had not changed. The candidate pool had not expanded. What changed was the engagement structure and the execution process.

60+ days	41 days	$275K
EACH FIRM, NO PLACED CANDIDATE	MAJHI GROUP CLOSE, SAME ROLE	VP TOTAL COMPENSATION PLACED

The previous firms operated on contingency. The incentive was placement speed. Candidates who moved quickly were advanced. Evidence-backed dossiers were absent. Shortlist recommendations were built on résumé assessment and recruiter judgment — none of it systematically recorded or defensible when the CEO asked "why this candidate?"

The retained engagement changed four things. First: the intake. Before a single outreach message was sent, a structured role brief defined the specific context the incoming VP would operate in — not the job description, but the actual organizational challenge. Second: verification. Every outreach sequence ran on DNS/MX verified contact data with bounce-kill logic active. Third: evidence. Every shortlisted candidate came with a structured dossier. Fourth: commitment structure. Milestones tied to delivery, not placement speed, aligned every decision toward quality.

WHAT RETAINED SEARCH ACTUALLY MEANS

CHAPTER 04 · HOW SEARCHES FAIL

The Four Ways Searches Fail

04

Most VP searches don't fail because of the talent market. They fail because of four specific infrastructure failure modes that compound across every stage of execution — and remain invisible until the timeline has already extended past recovery.

FAILURE MODE 01

Intake Without Normalization

Candidates arrive from LinkedIn exports, referrals, ATS imports, and CSV uploads in different formats with no deduplication logic. The same candidate enters the funnel twice. Quality gates fail silently on unstandardized profiles. A recruiter spends time evaluating someone who was already disqualified in a parallel mandate three weeks ago. None of this shows up on a recruiting dashboard. The timeline extends without a traceable cause.

FAILURE MODE 02

Outreach Without Verification

Most outreach sequences run on contact data that has never been verified — DNS records unvalidated, MX routing unchecked, bounce logic absent. The sequence fires. The messages appear sent. But delivery and receipt are different things. A domain with degraded reputation sends messages that route to spam. Reply rates start declining. No alert fires. The failure is discovered retrospectively — usually three weeks after it began, when the pipeline is already thin and recovery options have narrowed.

FAILURE MODE 03

Evaluation Without Evidence

When a CEO asks "why are you recommending this candidate," the answer should be traceable — specific proof points, documented risk flags, a fit assessment with an evidence trail. In most searches, the answer is an impression: "She has a strong background, the hiring manager liked her, she performed well in interviews." This is not evidence. Impression-based shortlists trigger CEO rejections. Rejections trigger rework. Rework extends the timeline. The same candidates are re-evaluated with different criteria two weeks later.

FAILURE MODE 04

Execution Without Observability

A search can be technically in progress — messages sending, profiles being reviewed, interviews scheduled — while the pipeline is functionally stalled. Without real-time visibility into mandate health states and stall detection, the search degrades silently. The recruiter is working. The hiring manager is waiting for updates. Leadership is assuming progress. And somewhere in the fragmented tool stack, the search is failing. The tools don't share state. The reporting tool produces a retrospective view. Leadership receives weekly summaries that are already a week stale by the time they arrive.

WHY WEEK TEN IS THE FAILURE POINT

These four modes amplify each other. Bad intake → reduced capacity → less rigorous verification → lower reply rates → thinner pipeline → evaluation pressure → poor shortlists → CEO rejections → rework → extended timeline. Each cycle of

CHAPTER 05 · HOW SEARCHES FAIL

05

Why VP Searches Stall at Week Ten

68% of VP-level searches stall past week 10. This is not random. The research on this is consistent, and the operational data from tracking mandates over multiple years confirms it. Week ten is where searches go to quietly fail — and where they are most expensive to recover.

The Operational Visibility Gap

The actual cause of most stalled VP searches is operational invisibility. Something went wrong in the search three to four weeks before the stall became visible — a reply rate that started declining, an outreach sequence running on a degrading domain, two candidates being contacted across overlapping mandates without anyone noticing.

These are execution failures, not market failures. But because the recruiting stack cannot see inside itself — because the ATS doesn't know what the sequencer is doing, the sequencer doesn't know what the enrichment tool found, and the reporting tool produces a retrospective view rather than a real-time signal — the failure is invisible until it's already expensive to fix.

> *The recruiter is working. The hiring manager is waiting for updates. Leadership is assuming progress. And somewhere in the five-tool stack producing five separate data feeds with no unified signal, the search is failing silently.*
>
> OPERATIONAL VISIBILITY GAP — THE DEFINING FAILURE OF FRAGMENTED SEARCH INFRASTRUCTURE

What the Gap Actually Costs

Framing a stalled search as a talent market problem is costly because it leads to the wrong interventions. Teams respond by expanding the candidate pool, lowering the bar, or adding urgency to outreach — none of which address operational failure. The actual cost compounds every week:

- Leadership bandwidth consumed by an open seat that should have been filled
- Candidate attrition — strong candidates accept other offers while the search stalls
- Domain reputation degradation from continued unverified outreach
- Organizational cost of decisions deferred waiting for the role to be filled
- Compounding rework as rejection cycles increase without root-cause analysis

What Changes With Real-Time Visibility

When reply rate decay triggers an alert before the sequence exhausts itself, recovery options exist. When duplicate candidate detection fires at intake, funnel integrity is preserved. When stall probability reaches a threshold, escalation happens automatically — the hiring manager receives context before they need to ask.

SEARCH PERFORMANCE: FRAGMENTED VS. INFRASTRUCTURE

REPLY RATE — UNVERIFIED OUTREACH 14%

REPLY RATE — DNS/MX VERIFIED OUTREACH **35%**

SHORTLIST APPROVAL — IMPRESSION-BASED **38%**

SHORTLIST APPROVAL — EVIDENCE-BACKED **82%**

MEDIAN TIME-TO-CLOSE — INDUSTRY AVERAGE **14 weeks**

AVERAGE TIME-TO-CLOSE — MAJHI GROUP RETAINED **50 days**

THE IMPLICATION

The difference between a 50-day close and a 120-day close is not the talent market. It is whether the search has operational observability — the ability to see the failure coming before it has already compounded. Week ten is not inevitable. It is the predictable result of an architecture that cannot see inside itself.

CHAPTER 06 · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Intelligence Hiring vs. Traditional Hiring

06

The difference between intelligence hiring and traditional hiring is not a technology difference. It is a question of what the process is designed to produce — and what it is actually capable of evaluating.

What Traditional Hiring Produces

Traditional executive hiring is optimized to produce shortlists. You define a role, source candidates, screen them against the definition, and present the ones who pass the screen. The recruiter's job is to generate options. The client chooses from them.

This model was designed for a world where information was scarce. Identifying qualified candidates required significant effort, and the recruiter's primary value was the rolodex — the database of people and the relationship network that allowed access to them. Information scarcity is no longer the binding constraint. LinkedIn and a dozen other tools have made identification relatively cheap. The binding constraint is now judgment.

The Question That Changes Everything

Intelligence hiring starts from a different question. Not "who fits the requirements?" but "what does success in this role actually look like, and what produces it?"

These seem like the same question. They are not. "Who fits the requirements?" is answered by comparing candidate profiles to a job description. "What does success in this role look like?" requires understanding the organization's current state, the specific challenges the new hire will face, the cultural dynamics that will affect their effectiveness, and the organizational history that contextualizes why the role exists.

This analysis typically produces a required profile that is substantially different from the job description. Roles are advertised with experience requirements that are the legacy of who previously held them — not reflections of what the new context demands.

The Three Executive Failure Modes

Understanding why executives fail clarifies what intelligence hiring is actually trying to prevent:

FAILURE MODE 01

Context Mismatch

The most common cause — a capable person placed in an environment that requires a different kind of capability than they have developed. The VP of Sales who scaled a Series D company is a different person than the one who needs to build a function from scratch at Series A. Same title. Completely different requirements.

FAILURE MODE 02

CHAPTER 07 · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

07

The Evidence-Backed Shortlist

The difference between a 38% shortlist approval rate and an 82% approval rate is not the quality of the candidates. It is the quality of the recommendation. Impression-based shortlists fail. Evidence-backed shortlists close.

Why Shortlists Fail

When a CEO or board passes on a shortlisted candidate, the explanation is almost always something generic: "not quite the right fit," "the team wasn't convinced," "we'd like to see more options." These explanations feel like feedback. They are not. They are signals that the recommendation was not defensible — that the case for the candidate could not be made in terms the decision-maker could evaluate.

Impression-based shortlists cannot produce defensible recommendations because impressions are not evidence. When a hiring recommendation is built on "she has a strong background and the hiring manager liked her," there is nothing to interrogate, nothing to verify, and nothing to build on when the recommendation is rejected. The search restarts from zero.

What an Evidence Dossier Contains

An evidence-backed dossier for each shortlisted candidate contains four elements: a proof-points brief documenting specific achievements that map to the role brief's criteria; a risk-flags assessment identifying where context mismatch or capability gaps may exist; a reference summary from structured conversations with people who have managed the candidate or seen them operate under pressure; and a fit score against each criterion in the role brief with the reasoning documented.

SHORTLIST APPROVAL RATE — IMPRESSION-BASED	38%	→	82%	SHORTLIST APPROVAL RATE — EVIDENCE-BACKED
SHORTLIST ROUNDS BEFORE HIRE — IMPRESSION-BASED	4–5	→	1–2	SHORTLIST ROUNDS BEFORE HIRE — EVIDENCE-BACKED
AUDIT TRAIL COVERAGE — FRAGMENTED PROCESS	9%	→	100%	AUDIT TRAIL COVERAGE — EVIDENCE-BACKED PROCESS

The Reference Conversation

Most reference checks are performative. The candidate provides three names. The recruiter calls them. Everyone says positive things. No decision-useful information is produced.

Structured reference conversations are different. They probe specifically for the challenges the candidate will face in the new role. They ask referees to compare the candidate to the best person they have ever seen in the same function. They explore how the candidate has navigated the specific type of context transition the new role requires. They are conversations designed to surface the information that does not appear in interviews or on résumés.

CHAPTER 08 · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Integration: Where Companies Lose the Hire They Just Made

Most organizations consider the search complete at the point of offer acceptance. They have found the person. The job is done. This is the moment where the third most common executive failure mode begins.

The Forgotten Stage

Integration failure — the new leader's inability to build the relationships and organizational understanding needed to be effective — accounts for a significant portion of the 40% failure rate. It is preventable, but prevention requires investment after the offer is accepted, not before. Most organizations do not make this investment.

The reason integration fails is well understood: senior leaders join with high expectations and significant pressure to demonstrate value quickly. This pressure creates an incentive to move fast — to make decisions before fully understanding the organizational context. The decisions made quickly and without adequate organizational knowledge produce friction. The friction reduces the trust available for subsequent decisions. The leader becomes progressively isolated.

Three Integration Failure Patterns

PATTERN 01

The Early Win Trap

The new leader is expected to demonstrate value in the first 90 days. They make visible changes quickly to signal competence. The changes are made without sufficient organizational context. They produce resistance. The leader interprets the resistance as organizational dysfunction. The organization interprets the leader's response as inflexibility. The relationship deteriorates before either party fully understands what went wrong.

PATTERN 02

The Missing Network

Effectiveness in senior roles is significantly dependent on informal relationships — the people who provide honest feedback, the ones who surface information that doesn't flow through formal channels, the coalition required to move decisions across organizational boundaries. Building this network takes time and deliberate effort. Leaders who are under pressure to demonstrate formal results often neglect it. They become effective at operating within their direct function and ineffective at operating across it.

PATTERN 03

Context Deprivation

The new leader does not know the organizational history that explains why the situation they are inheriting exists in the form they find it. Why was the previous approach chosen? What has already been tried? What are the political dynamics that constrain options? Without this context, they repeat experiments that have already failed, step on organizational landmines that could have been mapped, and make proposals that trigger resistance whose origins they cannot understand.

Who Owns Integration

Integration is owned by the organization — not the new hire. The new hire cannot onboard themselves. They cannot build context they are not given access to. They cannot navigate organizational dynamics they have not been briefed on.

The organizations that consistently achieve high executive retention invest in structured integration programs: defined relationship-building sequences for the first 90 days, explicit briefings on organizational history and context, designated internal sponsors who surface the informal information the new leader needs, and check-in conversations that give early warning of the patterns that, uncorrected, become integration failures.

THE INTEGRATION COMMITMENT

A search firm that is genuinely committed to the outcome — not just the placement — supports the integration stage. At Majhi Group, the engagement does not end at offer acceptance. The first 90 days include structured check-ins, early warning identification, and where necessary, direct mediation between the new leader and the organizational context they are navigating. The 90-day replacement guarantee is the floor. The goal is to never need it.

CONCLUSION · SECTION 10

What 50 Days Looks Like

A search that closes in 50 days is not a faster version of a search that takes 14 weeks. It is a different architecture. Different intake. Different evaluation. Different incentive structure. Different visibility. Different accountability.

The Full System

The 50-day close emerges from a system that is designed, at every stage, to produce a quality outcome rather than merely a hire. The role brief defines the search correctly before it starts. The retained structure aligns incentives toward quality. DNS/MX verified outreach preserves domain reputation and produces reply rates that reflect actual engagement. Evidence-backed evaluation produces shortlists that move through to offer without rework. Structured integration prevents the integration failures that turn a good hire into a failed one 14 months later.

Each component is independently valuable. The compounding effect of all of them operating together is what produces the 50-day benchmark. Remove any one of them and the system degrades. Remove several and you are back to the 14-week median.

Stage Conventional Search Majhi Group Approach Role definition Job description (inherited) Role brief (context-derived) Engagement structure Contingency — speed incentive Retained — quality incentive Outreach Unverified, domain degrades DNS/MX verified, 35% reply rate Shortlist Impression-based, 38% approval Evidence dossier, 82% approval Timeline 14 weeks industry median 50 days average Integration Ends at offer acceptance 90-day structured support Guarantee Rarely offered 90-day replacement standard

What This Means for Your Next Search

If you are about to begin a VP or C-suite search, three questions matter before you start:

First: Do you have a role brief — not a job description, but a specific account of what the incoming leader needs to accomplish and what organizational context they will be operating in? If not, the search should not start yet.

Second: Is the fee structure aligned to quality, or to speed? A contingency structure will produce a hire. It will not reliably produce the right hire. If you cannot afford the wrong hire — and at VP level, almost no organization can — the fee structure matters.

Third: Who owns integration? If the answer is "the new hire," the 40% failure rate applies. If the answer is a structured program with executive sponsorship and clear accountabilities, your probability of success is substantially higher.

THE CORE ARGUMENT, RESTATED

The 40% failure rate for executive hires is not a law of nature. It reflects a process optimized to fill roles rather than to produce successful leaders. The gap between those two objectives is where most of the failures live — and where the 50-day close lives too.

APPENDIX

About Majhi Group

Majhi Group is a retained executive search firm placing VP and C-suite leaders globally. We are not a recruiter. We are not a staffing agency. We are a search firm that deploys a system.

Track Record

25+	30–45 days	90%+
C-SUITE AND VP PLACEMENTS COMPLETED	AVERAGE CLOSE VS 65–90 DAY INDUSTRY MEDIAN	OFFER ACCEPTANCE RATE

Engagement Model

Every engagement is retained — committed, exclusive, and aligned to quality outcomes.

STANDARD ENGAGEMENT TERMS

— **Fee structure:** 20–25% of total compensation

— **Payment schedule:** 1/3 upfront at signing · 1/3 after candidate submission · 1/3 after placement

— **Commitment:** Exclusivity required · 45-day minimum engagement

— **Guarantee:** 90-day replacement at no additional charge

— **Reporting:** Weekly status reports throughout the search

— **Integration:** Structured support through the first 90 days post-placement

Who We Work With

Majhi Group works directly with CEOs and Founders. We do not engage through HR teams or intermediaries. Our clients are organizations where the search matters enough to the CEO that they are personally involved in the brief and the decision.

We specialize in VP and C-suite placements at growth-stage companies — typically Series A through Series C — where executive hiring velocity is mission-critical and the cost of a wrong hire is existentially high.

We do not work with pre-revenue startups, contingency-only buyers, or roles under $150K total compensation.

Work With Manas Majhi

The starting point is a 20-minute confidential search assessment — a structured conversation about whether your search criteria are optimized for the specific hire you need to make. It is not a sales call. It is an honest evaluation.

REQUEST A SEARCH ASSESSMENT